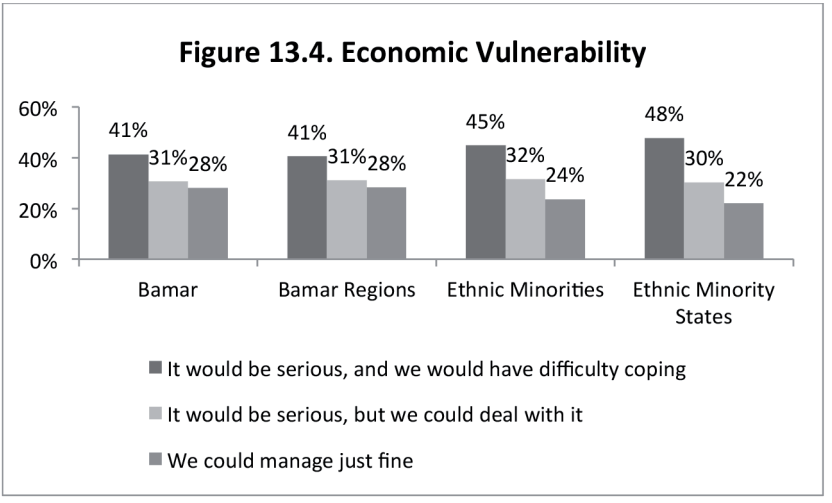
the differences are not as sharp. Both the Bamar majority and ethnic minorities indicate similar levels of economic difficulties. Slightly over fifty per cent of respondents — Bamar and ethnic minorities alike — say they have difficulty covering basic needs. Poverty is a serious problem in Myanmar and all communities suffer from it.

These shared experiences are echoed when asked about economic vulnerability detailed in Figure 13.4. A majority of nearly all communities acknowledged they would have difficulties making ends meet if they lost their monthly income. Ethnic minorities, especially in ethnic minority states, recorded relatively higher economic vulnerability than citizens in Bamar majority areas. These areas rely heavily on incomes from migrant labour abroad and the diaspora community, which can be irregular sources of income. This finding confirms the view that perceived economic vulnerabilities tend to be slightly higher among ethnic minorities.



When asked about income distribution, public perceptions differ dramatically. Although a majority of Bamar believe national income distribution is unfair, the perception is more negative among ethnic minorities, as in Figure 13.5 (over page). This reaffirms the more negative perceptions of ethnic minorities regarding discrimination and governance discussed above.